

Chapter 112-2

"Do you know?" After a long silence, Gu Xingyue raised her hand and placed it on the table, not hiding the mark on her wrist. Her voice was very light and soft as she changed the direction of the topic. "I used to always think that compromising and enduring everything would make things better for everyone. But now I've realized that compromising only makes bad people become even worse."

"I was abandoned at the orphanage." Gu Xingyue said, "The director said that when he found me, I was only a few months old. At that time, my face had broken out in a large rash, and I could barely cry anymore. One of my feet was wrapped in bandages—there was something wrong with my leg. If I cried too long, my heart would become oxygen-deprived. But even then, I didn't die."

Liang Shi listened quietly, her heart involuntarily tightening.

Hearing such things always made one feel sad along with them.

"The illnesses in my body are because I cried for a very long time as a child. I didn't die, but I was left with a bunch of chronic conditions. My heart isn't good, so I can't do vigorous exercise. I can't handle too much stimulation. When my emotions get too intense, I faint. I walk and react half a beat slower than others. It's probably what people nowadays often call having a strong 'dull sense.'¹" Gu Xingyue spoke at an unhurried pace, calm and composed as if telling someone else's story, her emotions without much fluctuation.

"They all say having a strong dull sense is a good thing, but my dull sense is different from ordinary people's. I react to things half a beat slower, and my emotions also respond half a beat slower—it's just that I don't feel sad in the moment. But I'm fine. Becoming Qi Jiao has already become a part of my life. I've never even thought about how I should live as Gu Xingyue." Gu Xingyue also laid her cards on the table very honestly with Liang Shi. "I never thought about cooperating with you, nor did I think about giving you Qi Jiao's diary. I've always felt that you were speaking without knowing the pain²—you don't know what I've been through. All you've experienced was only the earliest version of Yang Jiani's madness."

How crazy Yang Jiani became later was beyond what a normal person could imagine.

"I dare say that if I died now, she would immediately rush to find the next replacement without stopping." Gu Xingyue said coldly, "And she could grind my bones to ashes and whip my corpse ten thousand times."

Maybe even more than that.

This woman's obsession and possessiveness had reached an appalling level.

"The reason I'm telling you all this is to say—" Gu Xingyue paused, then looked at Liang Shi sincerely.

Their eyes met. Liang Shi saw a firm light in Gu Xingyue's eyes. "I'm willing to trust you now. But if you want to run away halfway, I won't blame you either. I just hope you can pass my letter to my brother."

"I won't run away." Liang Shi said, "This battle—I can fight alongside you until the very end."

She couldn't accompany Qi Jiao back then, so now she would accompany Gu Xingyue.

Bad people must always pay the price.

The truth may be late, but it must arrive.

"Whether you're there or not." Gu Xingyue curved her lips into a smile, her fingernails tracing over the blue-green porcelain cup. Her long eyelashes fluttered, and in her eyes was a firm light that had never been there before. "I will take back everything."

All the hardships and grievances she had experienced over these years—she would reclaim them all.

For no other reason than that she wanted to be Gu Xingyue now.

What use was someone else's thirty percent of sincerity?

Better to fight for it herself.

At worst, things would just stay as they were.

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1. "Dull sense" (鈍感力, *dunganli*) refers to a psychological concept popularized in East Asia, meaning the ability to be less sensitive to negative stimuli, criticisms, or stressful situations. It's often seen as a form of emotional resilience or thick-skinnedness. ↩
 2. "Speaking without knowing the pain" (站着說話不腰疼) is a Chinese idiom that literally translates to "one's back doesn't hurt when standing and talking." It means it's easy to give advice or make comments when you're not the one suffering or dealing with the problem. ↩